only the attributes relevant to a specific policy while giving the holder control over which credentials to use and how to disclose them.

Figure 16.3 illustrates this step in isolation. This is the final part of the flow in the trust triangle from figure 16.1: the holder presenting verifiable claims to the verifier. Here, we focus only on that step, showing how the PEP sends an attribute query, the holder's wallet assembles an appropriate presentation based on the user's request, and the PEP receives the resulting claims for policy evaluation.

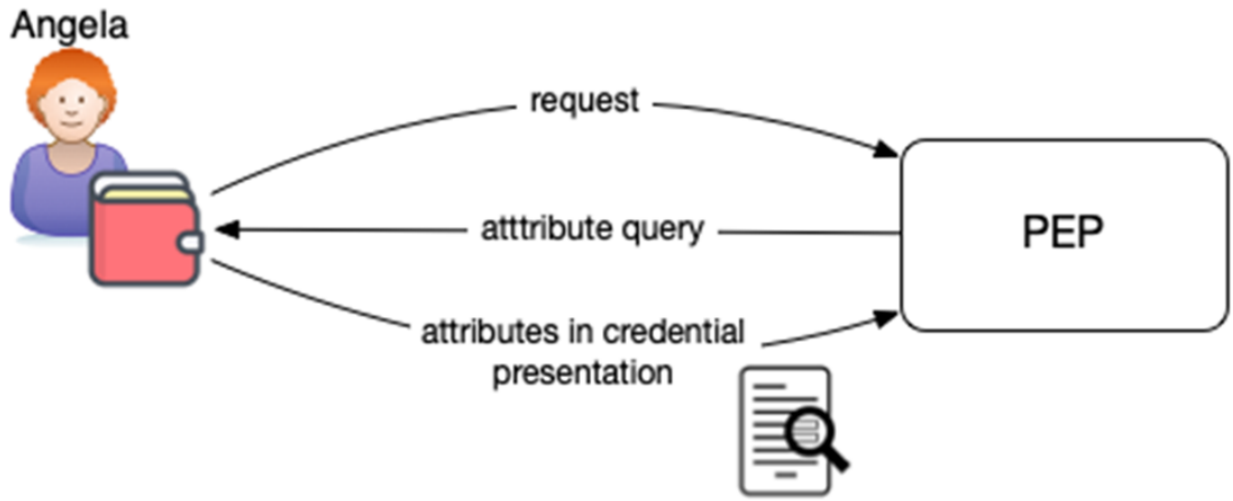


Figure 16.3 Claim-based credential presentation. Upon receiving an access request, the PEP requests specific attributes it needs for the authorization decision. The holder's wallet receives the attribute query, selects the necessary claims from one or more credentials, and assembles a signed presentation. The PEP verifies the presentation and prepares the claims for policy evaluation.

The attribute query identifies the claims that the PEP needs. The holder's wallet reviews its credentials, finds those with the necessary claims, and creates a signed presentation containing only the required information. The presentation is not the credential itself; rather, it is a derivative object specifically generated for the request, enabling selective disclosure and the combination of claims from multiple sources.

This mechanism offers ACME flexibility that isn't possible with federation or static directory synchronization. When Angela logs in to systems that keep audit-related documents and logs, the PEPs for those systems check the metadata of the policies that apply to her request to decide which attributes